

Space Age

Mankind's oldest mystery, the moon, is always brighter on the other side. We explore some odd theories.

**Who is "Spamford" Wallace?**

The world's most notorious spammer, that's who. Read about the decade long quest to finally catch him here: <http://dgit.in/spamrr>

The elusive dream to create vast amounts of energy using simple reactions has always been a dream. Which leads us to the question...

Whatever Happened To Cold Fusion?

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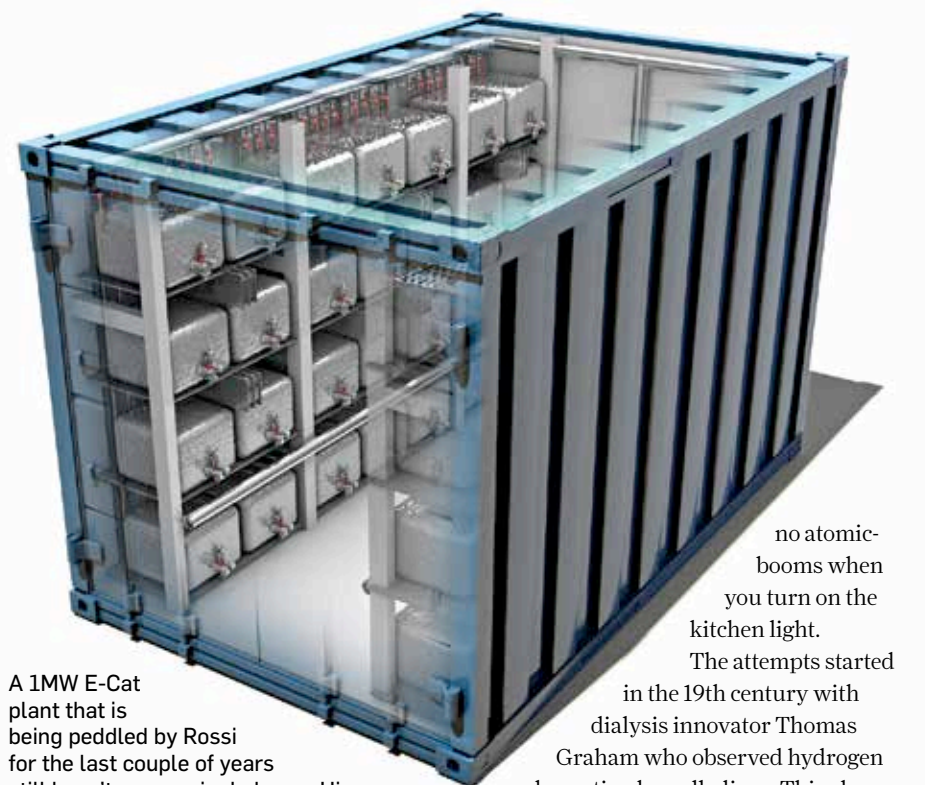
In Greek mythology Prometheus defied Zeus and stole fire for humanity. The Rig Veda tells the story of Matarisvan, a hero figure who secretly transported fire to the Bhrigus. The history of human imagination is littered with the idea of acquiring power.

More than an idea, at times it has become an obsession - the desire to receive more than we give - it is human nature at its most basic. And just as fire played the decisive role in igniting the technological revolution, so does the potential of cold fusion. Shrouded in hoaxes, myths and bad publicity cold fusion is the holy grail of energy scientists across the world but we must ask ourselves - is it even real?

Prometheus and Matarisvan Walk Into A Lab

The quest to create vast amounts of energy through simple reactions is persistent; from gunpowder to dynamite. A simple problem - to start a self-sustained process where more energy is released than invested in a nuclear reaction. Oh wait. Didn't we do that already?

Yes. There is that old recipe - a little bit of Uranium-235, a spare neutron and presto you have nuclear fission. For the chef's special, direct the nuclear fission energy to a mix of fusion materials - Uranium-238, Lithium-6 deuteride and a dash of Plutonium. Chef calls it a fission-fusion reaction. Bon appetite. Oh just one



A 1MW E-Cat plant that is being peddled by Rossi for the last couple of years still hasn't seen a single buyer. His new launch date is in early 2014! SHUT UP and Don't Touch My Money!

thing - the aftermath might be a little more radioactive than you're used to.

Always a catch, eh? We all want that plentiful supply of energy - a warm light for all mankind (as Loki so eloquently put it) but without the collateral death and destruction, and can it be not radioactive as well. This is where the concept of cold fusion arises - all the tasty energy with none of the indigestion. Meaning

no atomic-booms when you turn on the kitchen light.

The attempts started in the 19th century with dialysis innovator Thomas Graham who observed hydrogen absorption by palladium. This observation became the foundation of cold fusion research. But it was only in 1926, that Austrian scientists Friedrich Paneth and Kurt Peters attempted an experiment to transform hydrogen into helium at room temperature (the sun does the same thing but at 15 million Kelvin or $1.5 \times 10^7^\circ\text{C}$ - a bit uncomfortable). They were unsuccessful.

They were followed by others including Swedish scientist J. Tandberg who innovatively started using the newly discovered deuterium (heavy hydrogen) isotope and even went so far as to apply for a patent